

BRIAN SANTIAGO

SOC Analyst | Alert Triage & Threat Detection | Incident Response | SIEM | Microsoft Sentinel | KQL | MITRE ATT&CK | Security+

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

SOC Analyst with 3+ years of security operations experience across regulated healthcare and education environments, specializing in alert triage, threat detection, incident documentation, and escalation support. Serves as a first line of defense by correlating alerts across SIEM, EDR, and identity platforms; executing playbook-driven escalation procedures; and documenting IOCs and investigation timelines. Built a Microsoft Sentinel SOC home lab on live attack telemetry — engineered and tuned 8 KQL detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK techniques, reducing false positives by approximately 35%. Experienced in SLA-driven triage queues, continuous monitoring, and producing structured escalation documentation that meets real SOC standards.

SOC HOME LAB — MICROSOFT SENTINEL & MITRE ATT&CK

Microsoft Sentinel Detection Lab | Azure | KQL | Sysmon | MITRE ATT&CK | n8n | 2024 – Present

- Needed hands-on SOC practice beyond ticket work — deployed Azure VM honeypots and ingested live attack telemetry (authentication events, firewall logs, Sysmon data, network flows) into Microsoft Sentinel to simulate a production security monitoring environment with genuine attack traffic.
- Brute-force and credential attacks needed repeatable detection logic — engineered 8 KQL analytics rules targeting brute-force logins (T1110), credential stuffing (T1078), lateral movement (T1021), and MFA bypass indicators (T1556); iteratively tuned each rule against live data, reducing false positive rate by approximately 35%.
- Manual alert investigation lacked repeatable escalation output — built Sentinel incident dashboards, IOC enrichment workflows, and n8n-automated escalation summaries that produced structured, consistent escalation packages from raw alert data, mirroring real SOC documentation standards.

CORE COMPETENCIES

SOC Operations: Alert Triage, Security Event Monitoring, First Line of Defense, SIEM-Based Detection, SLA-Driven Triage, Playbook Execution, Escalation Procedures, Continuous Monitoring, False Positive Review

Detection & Analysis: Microsoft Sentinel, KQL Analytics Rules, IOC/IOA Identification, Log Correlation, False Positive Tuning, Detection Rule Development, Security Dashboard Monitoring, Alert Prioritization

Threat Intelligence: MITRE ATT&CK Framework, Kill Chain Analysis, Brute Force Detection, Credential Stuffing, Lateral Movement Indicators, Suspicious Login Analysis, Threat Hunting Fundamentals

Incident Response: Containment & Remediation Support, Post-Incident Documentation, NIST SP 800-61 Workflows, Incident Ticket Management, Root Cause Analysis, Evidence Gathering, SOC Escalation Notes, SOP/Playbook Development

Endpoint & Identity: Microsoft Defender, NinjaOne EDR, Active Directory, Entra ID, MFA Anomaly Investigation, Conditional Access, Endpoint Hardening, Windows Event Logs, Sysmon

Tools: Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk (Log Review), Wireshark, ServiceNow, Event Viewer, PowerShell, KQL, NIST SP 800-61, CIS Controls, HIPAA, SOX

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Support Specialist — Security & SOC Focus | Ina A. Colen Academy | Ocala, FL | Jul 2025 – Present

- Security-related alerts were buried across NinjaOne EDR, Event Viewer, Entra ID, and ServiceNow with no triage structure — built a correlated alert review process across all four platforms, reducing time-to-escalation for identity and endpoint threats from hours to under 30 minutes.
- Suspicious sign-ins and account changes needed investigation before escalation — reviewed failed logon sequences, MFA anomalies, endpoint health indicators, and user timelines; produced detailed escalation notes with supporting evidence and severity context for each confirmed incident.
- Endpoint attack surface was inconsistently hardened across 200+ systems — applied playbook-driven patching, GPO hardening, and configuration remediation, reducing endpoint vulnerability exposure and producing a documented remediation record for security posture reporting.
- Incident handoffs lacked a repeatable evidence structure — developed incident documentation templates covering IOC/IOA capture, affected systems, investigation timeline, containment steps, and escalation rationale, improving handoff quality and post-incident review completeness.
- Identity-related incidents were recurrent and underdocumented — administered AD, Entra ID, Microsoft 365, MFA, and least-privilege access controls for 500+ users; investigated and remediated credential anomalies with documented root cause analysis and corrective action closure.

Tier 3 IT Support Specialist | Sanitas Medical Center | Remote / FL | Jan 2025 – May 2025

- Healthcare authentication anomalies needed timely investigation — analyzed Entra sign-in behavior, VPN logs, endpoint activity, Event Viewer records, and ServiceNow tickets using structured procedures aligned to HIPAA/SOX incident documentation requirements, separating user errors from potential security events.
- Security stakeholders needed validated findings, not raw log data — gathered and correlated evidence using Splunk log queries, Wireshark captures, and Event Viewer analysis; produced structured escalation notes with severity assessment, affected scope, and recommended containment steps.
- Credential and access risks needed stronger controls — enforced MFA and access procedures that reduced credential-related ticket volume, with documented evidence supporting HIPAA/SOX-aligned security operations review.
- Response steps were inconsistent across recurring security tickets — authored NIST SP 800-61-aligned SOPs and escalation playbooks for five common event categories, standardizing triage steps and reducing mean time to contain for repeated event types.

Help Desk Technician | KM New Living Society | New York, NY | May 2023 – Aug 2024

- Endpoint and access problems created potential security exposure — reviewed Windows event logs, AD permissions, endpoint symptoms, and network connectivity to identify root cause, escalate security-relevant findings with supporting evidence, and close incidents with documented resolution.
- Audit requests required reliable security control evidence — collected AD, GPO, access, and endpoint configuration records tied to control objectives, contributing to work paper packages reviewed by external auditors and reducing evidence turnaround time.
- Ticket documentation quality varied across technicians — standardized incident notes, resolution steps, and escalation records across 400+ ServiceNow tickets for 150+ users; documentation was later reused to satisfy SOC 1/2 ITGC audit evidence requests.

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ | CompTIA Network+ | CompTIA A+ | Google Cybersecurity Certificate | MediClear HIPAA Compliance | CySA+ (In Progress — Target Q4 2026)

EDUCATION

High School Diploma — Piscataway High School, Piscataway, NJ